

Key of Her

R&B for solo piano, with lyrics — a house full of daughters

original composition

Bright R&B (♩ = 108)

A^{6 9}

bright, horns in unison

G¹³

F[♯]m¹¹

Bm¹¹

E¹³

A^{6 9}

The first system of musical notation for 'Key of Her' is in the key of D major (two sharps) and common time (C). It consists of a grand staff with a treble and bass clef. The tempo is marked as 'Bright R&B (♩ = 108)'. The first measure is marked with a forte 'f' dynamic. The melody in the treble clef is a series of eighth notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, C5, B4, A4, G4, F#4, E4, D4. The bass line consists of a steady eighth-note accompaniment: D3, E3, F#3, G3, A3, B3, C4, B3, A3, G3, F#3, E3, D3. Above the staff, the following chords are indicated: A^{6 9}, G¹³, F[♯]m¹¹, Bm¹¹, E¹³, and A^{6 9}. The text 'bright, horns in unison' is written below the first measure.

The second system of musical notation continues the piece. It begins with a mezzo-forte 'mf' dynamic. The melody in the treble clef continues with eighth notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, C5, B4, A4, G4, F#4, E4, D4. The bass line continues with eighth notes: D3, E3, F#3, G3, A3, B3, C4, B3, A3, G3, F#3, E3, D3. Above the staff, the following chords are indicated: A^{6 9}, F[♯]m¹¹, Bm¹¹, E¹³, A^{6 9}, and C[♯]m¹¹. The lyrics 'Morning comes in rib - bons down the stairway, Laughter in a lan-guage' are written below the staff.

The third system of musical notation continues the piece. It begins with a mezzo-forte 'mf' dynamic. The melody in the treble clef continues with eighth notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, C5, B4, A4, G4, F#4, E4, D4. The bass line continues with eighth notes: D3, E3, F#3, G3, A3, B3, C4, B3, A3, G3, F#3, E3, D3. Above the staff, the following chords are indicated: D^{Δ 9}, G¹³, A^{6 9}, F[♯]m¹¹, Bm¹¹, and E¹³. The lyrics 'all their own, Life keeps answering me back in daugh - ters,' are written below the staff.

The fourth system of musical notation continues the piece. It begins with a mezzo-forte 'mf' dynamic. The melody in the treble clef continues with eighth notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, C5, B4, A4, G4, F#4, E4, D4. The bass line continues with eighth notes: D3, E3, F#3, G3, A3, B3, C4, B3, A3, G3, F#3, E3, D3. Above the staff, the following chords are indicated: C[♯]m¹¹, F[♯]¹³, Bm¹¹, E¹³ sus4, D^{Δ 9}, C[♯]m¹¹, and F[♯]¹³. The lyrics 'Hand to hand the mel - o dy is grown. House full of daugh-ters,' are written below the staff.

15 Bm^{11} $E^{13} \text{ sus}^4$ E^{13} $D^{\Delta 9}$ $C\sharp m^{11}$ $C^{\Delta \sharp 11}$ Bm^{11}

Singing in the key of her, Mother, then daughter, then daughter a-gain,

19 Bb^{13} $A^{6 9}$ G^{13} $F\sharp m^{11}$

The song keeps turn-ing, and I get to hear.

23 Bm^{11} E^{13} $A^{6 9}$ $F\sharp m^{11}$ Bm^{11} E^{13}

mf Now their daughters run a-cross the garden,

27 $A^{6 9}$ $C\sharp m^{11}$ $D^{\Delta 9}$ G^{13} $A^{6 9}$ $F\sharp m^{11}$

Same bright eyes in some-one newly made, Every door I opened, they

30 Bm^{11} E^{13} $C\sharp m^{11}$ $F\sharp^{13}$ Bm^{11} $E^{13} \text{ sus}^4$

walk through it, Carry-ing the songs their mothers played.

33 $D^{\Delta 9}$ $C^{\#m11}$ $F^{\#13}$ Bm^{11} $E^{13} \text{ sus4}$ E^{13}

f House full of daugh-ters, Singing in the key of her,

37 $D^{\Delta 9}$ $C^{\#m11}$ $C^{\Delta \#11}$ Bm^{11} B^b_{13}

Mother, then daughter, then daughter a - gain, The song keeps turn - ing,

40 A^{69} $C^{\Delta 9}$ *detour to C* Am^{11} D^{13}

mp and I get to hear. Someone asked if I was wish - ing for a son,

43 $F^{\Delta \#11}$ $G^{13} \text{ sus4}$ G^{13} $D^{\Delta 9}$ $C^{\#m11}$

I just smiled and counted ev-ery one, Ev-ery braid and ev-ery ar -

46 Bm^{11} E^{13} $C^{\#m11}$ $F^{\#13}$ Bm^{11} $E^{13} \text{ sus4}$

gument I lose Is the life that I would al - ways choose.

49

A^{69} G^{13} $F\sharp m^{11}$ Bm^{11} E^{13} A^{69}

f

53

$E\flat^{\Delta 9}$ Dm^{11} G^{13} Cm^{11} $F^{13} \text{ sus4}$ F^{13}

ff *the next generation*

House full of daugh-ters, Singing in the key of her,

57

$E\flat^{\Delta 9}$ Dm^{11} $D\flat^{\Delta \sharp 11}$ Cm^{11} B^{13}

Mother, then daughter, then daughter a - gain, The song keeps turn - ing,

60

$B\flat^{69}$ $A\flat^{13}$ Gm^{11} Cm^{11} F^{13} $B\flat^{69}$

and I get to hear.